

Chapter 39-2: Divine Sword

After a very long time, the sounds outside finally ceased, so quiet it was as if no battle had ever taken place. Ning Fuyi then supported Chu Qingqiu while turning her own body to the outer side, reaching out to feel for the mechanism and press it down.

The door suddenly burst open. Outside was pitch black—the original night-illuminating pearls¹ had been destroyed, and broken stone fragments were everywhere. Both Bai Lin and the demon beast had disappeared without a trace.

"Chu Qingqiu," Ning Fuyi said softly. Chu Qingqiu hummed in response and withdrew from her embrace.

Her arms suddenly felt empty. Ning Fuyi lowered her arms and walked ahead of Chu Qingqiu.

Bai Lin had vanished to who knows where. Relying solely on hiding was completely impossible to escape those demon clan members. Only by quickly finding the Emei Thorn could they have a chance of surviving.

Chu Qingqiu covered her chest, her clear peach blossom eyes lifting to gaze at Ning Fuyi's dim silhouette in the darkness, lost in thought. Only when Ning Fuyi looked back did she slowly follow.

Ning Fuyi silently climbed over the rubble on the ground, walking along a path that had long lost all lighting. After walking for a long time, her view finally opened up.

The moment she stepped one foot inside, hundreds of lights suddenly lit up. Those lights were floating in mid-air, their brilliance filling the entire space.

The circular great hall was now covered in dust. Some stone carvings lay shattered on the ground, covering what had originally been a floor paved with gemstones. The coffered ceiling² overhead was several zhang³ high, painted with strange patterns using crystalline pigments.

The two exchanged a glance, then quickly looked away, carefully stepping inside.

This seemed to be the main hall of the Divine Meteorite. Ning Fuyi had never been to this place before, but as soon as she walked in, she felt a strange sense of connection.

The Emei Thorn was here—she was almost certain of it.

"What is that?" Ning Fuyi said in a low voice. In the center of the great hall, there seemed to be a sword stuck in the ground. The sword was plain and unremarkable, covered with dust.

Chu Qingqiu reached out to grasp the sword hilt and pulled hard, but the sword seemed to have grown into the ground, not moving a fraction.

"A fallen sword," Chu Qingqiu said. "After each god falls, their contracted sword shares their fate in life and death."

Ning Fuyi made a sound of acknowledgment and didn't look much at the sword.

But strangely, although that sense of connection was very strong, no matter how she searched, she couldn't find the slightest trace of the Emei Thorn.

"Looking for something?" A voice suddenly appeared at her ear, sounding like it came from the mouth of a corpse that had been dead for years.

The temperature around them suddenly plummeted, as if they had entered a glacier. Frost could be seen forming on the ground, and the faint sound of ten thousand people wailing echoed in their ears. For a moment it was like falling into hell. Chu Qingqiu's figure instantly appeared in front of Ning Fuyi, gripping the white bone in her hand tightly as she stared into the void.

"Come out," she said coldly.

That voice suddenly transformed into a sinister laugh, rapidly spinning between their left and right ears. Then a man's figure emerged from the air—a figure so tall it was frightening, his entire body covered completely by a black robe.

His face was hidden by a hood, under which was skin burned and covered with ravines, making it impossible to discern his features.

Ning Fuyi's heart sank, but she stared intently at the man, feeling that although the person before her was eerie, she seemed to have seen him somewhere before.

"Who are you?" Chu Qingqiu said in a low voice.

"Who I am isn't important," the corpse-like voice continued to rasp. "I'm not looking for you—I'm looking for her."

As he spoke, his charred fingertip pointed toward the space behind Chu Qingqiu. Ning Fuyi's pupils contracted slightly, but Chu Qingqiu's hand had somehow grasped her and forcefully positioned her behind herself.

Ning Fuyi looked down at the hand gripping her. The small wounds were still there, with little strength left.

"Are you looking for this?" The man's other hand, hidden within the black robe, was raised up. When Ning Fuyi saw clearly what it was, her heart sank like a stone thrown into a pond.

Hanging from his hand was the Emei Thorn, emitting black smoke and already bound to a master!

Ning Fuyi clenched her palms. Something that was destined to be hers in her previous life—how could it be easily taken by someone else now?

"Chu Ling Divine Venerable⁴," the man seemed very satisfied and began laughing again. His body leaned forward. "With only this little cultivation remaining, you still fantasize that you can protect her?"

"Foolish woman," he said disdainfully.

Like lightning striking her heart, Ning Fuyi's whole body felt electrified as she looked at Chu Qingqiu. What did he mean by "this little cultivation"?

Chu Qingqiu's weakness—was it not just because of her injuries?

"Whether I can protect her or not, you're welcome to try," Chu Qingqiu said in a low voice as cold white flames spread along the white bone.

"Leave quickly." Chu Qingqiu's lips didn't move, but her voice rang beside Ning Fuyi's ear, cold yet urgent. "Don't worry about me. I'll count to three, then you leave this place."

As soon as she finished speaking, she said "three," and white light suddenly blazed. Long winds surged from all directions, and white silk and white bone moved together, carrying desperate force as they rushed toward the man's heart and lungs.

"Chu Qingqiu!" Ning Fuyi cried urgently. A strong surge of anger rose in her heart. She didn't know why Chu Qingqiu was protecting her like this, nor did she know why she herself felt so furious.

Rubble continued falling around them. The man's powerful demonic energy swept across the sky. Ning Fuyi felt a stabbing pain in her heart and lungs and suddenly half-knelt down. The surroundings were once again engulfed by black smoke and wailing cries. In the rolling blood mist, only two blurred figures could be seen.

The man's hearty laughter came from within the black smoke. The power of the Emei Thorn summoned heavenly thunder—familiar thunder that exploded through the coffered ceiling and struck hard into the thick smoke.

Striking the woman's body.

So why, even after living again, would the things that belonged to her still be lost one by one? Why did she still have to be protected behind others, watching others die for her sake?

She was just a waste. No matter how many lifetimes she lived, she was just a waste who could only hide behind others.

Before, she didn't believe in fate. Now she did. Fate seemed to give her many paths, but when she walked them with hope, it sealed them off one by one.

Blood streaks were cut on her face by flying stones. Ning Fuyi suddenly let out a light laugh, straightening up and standing in the dust and sand, her thin body swaying precariously.

Forget it. Since heaven wanted her to be like this, she would accept her fate. If she couldn't cultivate to become an immortal and couldn't become a demon, then she would become a vengeful ghost. When the time came to destroy heaven and earth, that would also count as cultivation.

She randomly felt around nearby with her right hand, touched a sword hilt, and picked it up. Her body transformed into a shooting star falling into the rolling black smoke.

With her left hand exerting force, the woman's body was shielded in her embrace.

Footnotes:

- ¹ **Night-illuminating pearls (夜明珠)** - Magical pearls that glow in the dark, commonly used for lighting in cultivation settings.
- ² **Coffered ceiling (藻井)** - An ornate, sunken panel ceiling design, often found in important halls and temples in Chinese architecture.
- ³ **Zhang (丈)** - A traditional Chinese unit of measurement, approximately 3.33 meters or 10 feet.
- ⁴ **Chu Ling Divine Venerable (褚凌神尊)** - This appears to be Chu Qingqiu's full formal title, combining her surname Chu with "Ling" and the title "Divine Venerable."